

Practical 8

Problem Statement- Identify one real phishing email : A final-year student, Aman, receives a LinkedIn message saying:

“You are shortlisted for a Remote Software Developer role at Google.

Salary: ₹18 LPA.

Pay ₹2,499 as verification fee.

Limited seats. Pay now to confirm.”

ANSWER THE QUESTIONS :-

- a) What type of cybercrime is happening here?
- b) List 3 red flags that show it is a scam?
- c) What should he do to verify if a job offer is real?

Answer

a) What type of cybercrime is happening here? This is a Job Scam (a form of Phishing or Social Engineering). Specifically, it is an Advance-Fee Scam, where the attacker creates a sense of urgency to trick the victim into paying money for a fake opportunity.

b) List 3 red flags that show it is a scam?

- 1. Request for Payment: Legitimate companies, especially Google, will never ask a candidate to pay a "verification fee" or any upfront cost to secure a job.**
- 2. Sense of Urgency: The phrase "Limited seats. Pay now to confirm" is a classic tactic used to pressure victims into making impulsive decisions without**

thinking.

3. **Unrealistic Process:** Being "shortlisted" for a high-paying role (₹18 LPA) at a major tech company via a single LinkedIn message without a formal interview process is highly suspicious.

c) What should he do to verify if a job offer is real?

- **Check Official Channels:** Visit the official Google Careers portal to see if the job ID exists or if there is an application status under his profile.
- **Verify the Sender:** Check if the LinkedIn message came from a verified recruiter with a corporate email address (e.g., @<https://www.google.com/search?q=google.com>). Legitimate recruiters rarely use personal or generic email accounts.
- **Research the Policy:** Look up the company's official hiring policy. Most top-tier companies explicitly state on their websites that they do not charge any fees at any stage of the recruitment process.